THE WEEKEND BUILDER / FREE RESOURCE

Ask for feedback that helps

Watch a person try the task. Learn about the problem before asking them to judge your solution.

A short opening script

Thanks for helping me test this. I am testing the app, not you. Please try the task in your usual way and say what you are thinking. If something is confusing, that is useful feedback. You can stop at any time.

Five questions to ask

1. Tell me about the last time you needed to do this.
2. What did you use, and what was difficult?
3. What happened when you could not finish it?
4. What have you tried to make it easier?
5. Who else is involved in choosing or paying for a solution?

Give a neutral task

Instead of "Click the blue button to export", say "You need to send this result to a colleague. Show me how you would do that." Observe whether they finish, how long it takes, where they hesitate, and what they expect next.

Use evidence, not compliments

Separate what you saw from your interpretation. "User searched three menus before finding export" is an observation. "We need a bigger export button" is a proposed fix. Ask what outcome they wanted before choosing the fix.

End with a concrete next step

Ask whether they would try it again with their own non-sensitive sample data. If it fits, arrange a follow-up. Thank them without pressuring them to recommend or pay for the app.

WORKSHEET / IDEA & VALIDATION

Your feedback record

Write one sheet per person. Remove identifying or sensitive details before sharing.

Date / user type / task attempted

_____
_____

Their current approach and biggest frustration

_____
_____
_____

Observed behaviour: completed / hesitated / failed

_____
_____
_____

Exact words that matter (with permission)

_____
_____

My interpretation and alternative explanations

_____
_____

Next test or change, and why

_____
_____

Choose what to build next

Prioritise the issue that blocks the useful outcome. Look for repeated patterns across several users. Keep evidence that contradicts your original idea.